

Rebecca Pabst

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EDUCATION

- 📅 2022–2026 **PhD in Global Health and Tropical Medicine** (*expected completion: October 2026*)
[NOVA University, Institute of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine / FCT / AIR Centre](#) 📍 Lisbon, Portugal
» Dissertation: “Analysis of human-mediated changes in the global distribution of disease-vector mosquitoes”.
- 📅 2017–2021 **MSc in Landscape Ecology** *Grade: 1.4 (Very Good)*
[University of Münster](#) 📍 Münster, Germany
» Thesis: “Temporal transferability of habitat models on the occurrence of ilex hairstreak (*Satyrrium ilicis*) in active coppice woodlands”, *Grade: 1.3 (Very Good)*.
- 📅 2014–2017 **BSc in Landscape Ecology** *Grade: 2.1 (Good)*
[University of Münster](#) 📍 Münster, Germany
» Thesis: “Spatio-temporal variability of CH₄ and CO₂ emissions in the small shallow lake Heideweiher”, *Grade: 1.0 (Very Good)*.

SCHOLARSHIPS

- 📅 2020–2021 **RIVERSCALE**
[FCT Research Fellowship at CIBIO-InBio](#) 📍 Lisbon, Portugal
» Applied multivariate statistical methods to investigate and predict the distribution of invasive alien plants across riparian environments in continental Portugal.
- 📅 2019–2020 **ERASMUS+**
[Faculty of Sciences, University of Lisbon](#) 📍 Lisbon, Portugal
» Courses: Environmental geochemistry, applied geographic information systems, plant ecology, river ecology, bird ecology.
- 📅 2019 **Go East Summer School**
[DAAD Scholarship](#) 📍 Lake Baikal, Russia
» Summer school on conservation and ecology of the Lake Baikal region.
- 📅 2016 **Internship in Geology and Geophysics, UFRN**
[DAAD Scholarship](#) 📍 Natal, Brazil
» Analysis of rock samples for climate reconstruction using fossil records (ostracods).

WORK AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 📅 2025 **Tutor – Master’s Course**
[NOVA University, Institute of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine](#) 📍 Lisbon, Portugal
» Tutored students in methodological approaches linking climate and vector distributions, result interpretation, and quantitative research questions.
- 📅 2025 **InvaPact III Workshop**
[Institut Pascal, Université Paris-Saclay](#) 📍 Girona, Spain
» Collaborated with more than 60 international researchers to evaluate AI-based evidence-extraction methods and jointly analyse a database on invasive-species impacts.
- 📅 2025 **INOVEC Project – Field Testing of Mosquito Traps**
[Biogents AG](#) 📍 Brensbach, Germany
» Planned and conducted a one-month field experiment comparing two CO₂ sources for mosquito traps and assessing their suitability for vector surveillance.
- 📅 2024 **InvaPact II Workshop**
[Institut Pascal, Université Paris-Saclay](#) 📍 Paris, France
» Worked in an interdisciplinary team of more than 60 researchers to develop a shared framework for classifying and comparing invasive-species impacts.

-  2024

IWR Summer School: Applied Modelling of Climate-Sensitive Infectious Diseases

[Interdisciplinary Center for Scientific Computing](#) 📍 Heidelberg, Germany

» Completed advanced training in computational approaches for modelling climate-sensitive infectious diseases.
-  2023

Research Intern

[AIR Centre – Atlantic International Research Centre](#) 📍 Lisbon / Terceira, Portugal

» Integrated and analysed spatio-temporal spore, IoT-sensor, environmental, and remote-sensing data to improve an agricultural early-warning model ([spore risk alert](#)).
-  2022

Environmental Consultant

[enveco GmbH](#) 📍 Münster, Germany

» Evaluated ecological evidence and supported environmental impact assessments for wind-energy projects.
-  2022

Forest Inventory

[Forst Service Herdick](#) 📍 Germany

» Mapped, recorded, and assessed forest stands during ecological field surveys.
-  2018

Student Research Assistant

[University of Münster, Ecohydrology and Biogeochemical Cycles Group](#) 📍 Münster, Germany

» Conducted laboratory and field work and supported undergraduate teaching.

PUBLICATIONS

- » **Pabst, R.**, Sousa, C. A., Marler, A., Knoblauch, S., Capinha, C. (2026). [A global dataset of non-native distributions and biological and ecological traits for disease-vector mosquitoes](#). *Scientific Data*, including a visualisation [webtool](#), (accepted). Data and code: [Zenodo](#).
- » **Pabst, R.**, Sousa, C. A., Capinha, C. (2026). [Trait-based prediction of disease-vector mosquito invasion potential](#). *PLOS Neglected Tropical Diseases*; includes machine-learning imputation of incomplete trait data.
- » **Pabst, R.**, Sousa, C. A., Essl, F., García-Rodríguez, A., Liu, D., Lenzner, B., et al. (2025). [Global invasion patterns and dynamics of disease-vector mosquitoes](#). *Nature Communications*. Analysis code and data: [Zenodo](#).
- » Alves, G., Troco, A. D., Seixas, G., **Pabst, R.**, Francisco, A., Pedro, C., et al. (2024). [Molecular and entomological surveillance of malaria vectors in urban and rural communities of Benguela Province, Angola](#). *Parasites & Vectors*, 17, 112.
- » Ávila, M., Pinelo, J., Casas, E., Capinha, C., **Pabst, R.**, Szczesniak, I., et al. (2024). [Assessing the presence of *Pithomyces chartarum* in pastureland using IoT sensors and remote sensing: A case study of Terceira Island \(Azores, Portugal\)](#). *Sensors*, 24, 4485.
- » Graser, A., Kelling, M., **Pabst, R.**, Schulz, M., Hölzel, N., Kamp, J. (2023). [Habitat quality, not patch isolation, drives distribution and abundance of two light-demanding butterflies in fragmented coppice landscapes](#). *Journal of Insect Conservation*, 27, 743–758.
- » **Pabst, R.**, Dias, F. S., Borda-de-Água, L., Rodríguez-González, P. M., Capinha, C. (2022). [Assessing and predicting the distribution of riparian invasive plants in continental Portugal](#). *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution*, 10, 875578.

PRESENTATIONS AND SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- » **Deutschlandfunk Nova** (2026) – Radio interview: [So kommen Stechmücken durch den Winter](#).
- » **Parasitology in Portugal** (2026) – Oral presentation: [Trait-based assessment of invasive mosquitoes – which species are likely to spread next?](#)
- » **NOVA Health Conference** (2024) – Oral presentation: [Vector-borne diseases: The reason behind its increase](#).
- » **Neobiota Conference** (2024) – Oral presentation: [Database on the global human-mediated introduction of vector mosquitoes](#).
- » **IyrCIS Conference** (2024) – Oral presentation: [Database on the global human-mediated introduction of vector mosquitoes](#).
- » **TiBe Conference** (2023) – Poster presentation: [Invasion patterns of alien disease vector mosquitoes worldwide](#).

LANGUAGES

- » **German:** native
- » **English:** fluent
- » **Portuguese:** good

ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- » **PADI Assistant Instructor** – Scuba-diving assistant instructor with experience in leading groups and teaching in pools and lakes.
- » **Certified beekeeper**, German Beekeepers' Association.